BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #20 · AGING AND DECLINE

“People are just waiting for me to die.”

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Where it often comes from

When family talks about wills, care homes, or logistics, an older adult can hear impatience. Isolation, and the absence of visitors, can seem to confirm it. Some begin to feel like a burden or an inconvenience.

What Scripture teaches

God says, “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4). “Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails” is a prayer God answers. “You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God” (Leviticus 19:32). Honoring the aged is God’s command, and many love you. If you ever feel that life is not worth living, call or text 988 or tell someone now.

> *“Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you”* (Isaiah 46:4).

Also see

> “Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails” (Psalm 71:9).

> “You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God. I am the LORD” (Leviticus 19:32).

> “Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness” (Proverbs 16:31).

> “A father of the fatherless, and a defender of the widows, is God in His holy habitation. God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:5–6).

Common self-statements

- They want me gone.
- I am in the way.
- No one visits.
- My family is counting the days.
- I am just a problem.
- I do not matter anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either wanted or waiting to die.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one cares.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling lonely and concluding that I am unwanted.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a burden.

Challenging questions

- What have people actually said or done that makes me feel this way?
- Who has shown that they love me?
- Have I told someone how I feel?

- What does God say about my years?
- What could I ask my family for?
- Who could I connect with, like a church friend or neighbor?

Truth summary

> God will carry me to old age and beyond, and He commands respect for the elderly. I matter to Him and to people who love me. I can say what I feel, ask for time together, and reach out for support.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People are just waiting for me to die"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People are just waiting for me to die." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have people actually said or done that makes me feel this way?
- ☐ Who has shown that they love me?
- ☐ Have I told someone how I feel?
- ☐ What does God say about my years?
- ☐ What could I ask my family for?
- ☐ Who could I connect with, like a church friend or neighbor?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ God will not forsake me.
- ☐ The elderly are to be honored.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown.
- ☐ I can ask for connection.
- ☐ I matter.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."
- ☐ **Psalm 71:9**
  "Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails."
- ☐ **Leviticus 19:32**
  "You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God. I am the LORD."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Connected: Each week, note one visit, call, or kind word you received or gave.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 46:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will carry me and sustain me in my old age.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Tell someone. Share how you feel with a family member or friend.
- [ ] Ask for a visit. Request time together.
- [ ] Join a group. Connect with a senior group or church class.
- [ ] If you feel life is not worth living, call or text 988 (U.S.). Tell someone now.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People are just waiting for me to die": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Connected
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People are just waiting for me to die.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear being waited out. You have promised to carry me. Surround me with people who love me, and let me know that I matter. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.